Grade 12 Business Studies
Paper 2 Marking Guideline

150 marks available · Award only the marks shown. Accept other relevant, correctly explained answers. Avoid double-credit for repeated points.

Draft memo requires educator moderation and subject-specialist review before use.

SECTION A · ANSWER KEY (30 marks)

Item	Answer	Reason
1	B · Macro	One correct option; 2 marks.
2	A · a controllable capability	One correct option; 2 marks.
3	D · Fix a recorded variance	One correct option; 2 marks.
4	A · procurement	One correct option; 2 marks.
5	A · orient a new employee	One correct option; 2 marks.
6	B · early enough to inform the decision	One correct option; 2 marks.
7	A · consumer rights	One correct option; 2 marks.
8	A · observable and measurable	One correct option; 2 marks.
9	A · its members	One correct option; 2 marks.
10	A · total revenue equals total cost	One correct option; 2 marks.
11	A · market and operating assumptions	One correct option; 2 marks.
12	A · intellectual-property rights	One correct option; 2 marks.
13	A · inform decisions about customers	One correct option; 2 marks.

14	A · private interests may bias a duty	One correct option; 2 marks.
15	A · economic, social and environmental effects	One correct option; 2 marks.

SECTION B · MARKING GUIDELINES (80 counted)

Each question totals 40. Mark all three questions if attempted; retain the best two complete question scores, subject to school policy.

Question 1: Case study — Imbali Solar Co-operative (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
1.1	2 marks: using competitor photos risks copyright / intellectual-property infringement; 2 marks: misleading or unsubstantiated crowdfunding claims can damage trust or create legal/reputational exposure. Accept only distinct risks. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
1.2	Up to 4 paired comparisons: co-operative member ownership/participation versus company shareholding/directors; governance/decision process; ability to raise equity; liability/continuity subject to law and governing documents. Avoid unqualified liability claims. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.3	Up to 4 per method: prototype trials with target users and structured feedback; small preorder/deposit test with transparent terms; landing-page/price test; interviews/survey with defined sample. Explain evidence produced; do not infer demand. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.4	Up to 8: acknowledge/log complaint; test failure mode; check warranty/consumer obligations; repair/replace/refund where appropriate; communicate timing; improve design/quality control; monitor recurrence. Award response plus reason/application. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.5	Up to 12: credit can preserve cash for operations; compare financing cost and repayment timing with cash forecast; identify security/asset-loss exposure; check covenants and supplier dependency; negotiate capped pilot/terms; conditional recommendation on affordability/security review. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not	12

award unsupported assertions.

Question 2: Applied business ventures (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
2.1	Any four: executive/venture summary; market/customer analysis; marketing and sales plan; operations; management/team; financial forecasts/funding; risks and milestones. One mark per distinct element. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
2.2	Up to 8: define fixed costs, selling price and variable cost; calculate contribution; derive break-even volume (fixed cost ÷ contribution per unit); compare with realistic demand/capacity; state assumptions and margin-of-safety implication. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
2.3	Any four appropriate sources with stage/use fit (2 each): founder capital/bootstrapping; retained earnings; loan/overdraft; grant/prize; equity investor; supplier credit; crowdfunding with transparent terms. Explain one benefit or constraint each. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
2.4	Up to 10 comparative analysis: sole proprietor has simpler control but owner bears business risk and continuity depends on owner; private company has separate legal personality/continuity and can issue shares subject to law, but more governance/filing and shared control. Apply liability/control/continuity; avoid unqualified legal advice. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10
2.5	Benefits: identifies needs, willingness to pay, competitors and channel; supports pricing/forecast/testing. Limits: sample/bias, stale data, stated intent differs from purchase, cost/time and residual uncertainty. Conclude how to combine research with a small real test. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10

Question 3: Applied business roles (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
3.1	Any four: honesty; fairness/respect; accountability; transparency; confidentiality/privacy; integrity; avoiding harm/conflicts. One mark per applicable distinct principle. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
3.2	CSR is planned, sustained responsibility integrated into decisions and impacts; a once-off	8

	donation is limited and may not change business practices. Award for distinction, stakeholder/environment examples and explanation. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	
3.3	Any four actions, 2 each when explained: fair accessible recruitment; consistent criteria/pay; accommodation/accessibility; anti-harassment reporting; diverse voice in decisions; training and accountable review of outcomes. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
3.4	Up to 10: private benefit can bias a decision; unfair supplier/employee treatment harms stakeholders; disclose interests; recuse conflicted decision-maker; independent review/dual approval; maintain records and enforce policy. Link harm to control. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10
3.5	Up to 10 balanced response: economic viability and lifecycle cost; social effects on workers/community; environmental resource/emissions/waste effects; measurable targets and monitoring; trade-offs and feasible staged recommendation. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10

SECTION C · ESSAY GUIDELINE (40 marks)

Use the common rubric printed on the question paper: framing 4; accurate knowledge 12; analysis/application 12; evaluation/synthesis 8; structure and conclusion 4. Award proportionately for relevant, developed content; accept different defensible positions. A list without explanation cannot receive analysis or evaluation marks.

CAPS alignment and moderation note

Paper 2 addresses the Grade 12 topic pair: Business Ventures and Business Roles. The arrangement follows the DBE Business Studies examination guideline structure (Section A 30; Section B select two of three 40-mark questions; Section C select one of two 40-mark essays; 150 marks, 120 minutes). This is a newly authored practice draft; it is not an official DBE paper. CAPS source SHA-256: e6f0a21b96fa87ccfccb732a9240a579bf0157916b86a1cdd98a2876cf76db27. Before classroom use, an educator must validate topic coverage, the item-level mark scheme, accessibility and current examination policy.